

writings denouncing colonization, a campaign encouraging Black Americans to move to Liberia. He argued that the United States, and not Africa, was the rightful home of Black Americans. He gave a speech at the society's convention and was hired as a traveling lecturer by Garrison.

A career is launched

From 1841 to 1851, Douglass worked with the abolitionists allied with Garrison. These men sought to end slavery by peaceful means, through the education and moral persuasion of enslavers. Douglass rejected violence and, like Garrison, thought the existing political parties corrupt and the Constitution a pro-slavery document. In 1843, he toured the West giving speeches, and his skill as an orator improved rapidly. He became so eloquent, one white abolitionist advised him to keep “a little of the plantation manner” in his speech. Douglass, however, refused to conform to the public's expectations.

During the winter of 1844–45, Douglass wrote the first of three autobiographies. Friends advised him to destroy the manuscript for fear of it leading to his re-enslavement but Douglass was determined. The book was published in 1845, the first 5,000 copies selling out. It was a powerful indictment of the brutality and corruption that slavery inflicted on slaves, owners, and society. As sales increased, so did the danger, and Douglass fled to England, where he remained for two years, until two Englishmen “purchased” his freedom by paying his former master. Aged 28, he was now free to travel without fear. Douglass moved his family west to Rochester, New York, and set up a weekly anti-slavery newspaper, the *North Star*. Its slogan read, “Right is of no sex—Truth is of no color—God is the Father of us all, and we are all Brethren.” The paper advocated women's rights as well as abolition.

Fighting for freedom

In 1847, Douglass met the radical abolitionist John Brown, who convinced him that liberty should come at any price, whatever the